BandSix

TOEFL iBT® PREP · 2026 FORMAT · B2–C1

TEACHER LESSON PLANS

Listening

17 day plans · 3-hour classes · 30–45 minutes teacher-led

Each plan gives you a minute-by-minute run sheet for the class, what to present, a board plan, likely errors, concept-check questions, support and stretch tasks, an exit ticket and the student work to collect.

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Days marked “ETS lesson” match a free ETS TOEFL iBT® lesson plan: use your own copy of that plan in class.

HOW TO USE THESE PLANS

Listening: 17 classes at a glance

Every class lasts **3 hours**. You lead the first part (a 10-minute warm-up and **30–45 minutes** of presentation); students then work on the BandSix day for about two hours while you circulate, and the class ends with a 10-minute exit ticket. Times in the run sheet are a guide: the platform minutes come from the BandSix day itself. Strategy and tutorial stages are covered in your presentation, so students only skim them on the platform. A day unlocks only when every activity of the previous day is checked, so anything not finished in class becomes homework.

DAY	TITLE	TASK FOCUS	ETS LESSON TO USE IN CLASS
1	**Inside the new Listening section**	All Listening tasks	Listening Lesson 1 · Listening Introduction
2	**Choose a Response I: question types**	Listen and Choose a Response	Listening Lesson 2 · Listen and Choose a Response
3	**Choose a Response II: indirect answers**	Listen and Choose a Response	–
4	**Choose a Response III: sound traps**	Listen and Choose a Response	–
5	**Stress, intonation and implied meaning**	Choose a Response · Conversation	Listening Lesson 4 · Stress and Intonation
6	**Conversations I: gist and purpose**	Listen to a Conversation	Listening Lesson 3 · Living in a Dorm
7	**Conversations II: suggestions and next actions**	Listen to a Conversation	–
8	**Conversations III: inference and speaker attitude**	Listen to a Conversation	Listening Lesson 5 · Choosing a Presentation Topic
9	**Announcements I: purpose and action**	Listen to an Announcement	–
10	**Announcements II: details under pressure**	Listen to an Announcement	–
11	**Academic Talks I: topic and organization**	Listen to an Academic Talk	–
12	**Academic Talks II: examples and purpose**	Listen to an Academic Talk	–
13	**Academic Talks III: definitions and comparisons**	Listen to an Academic Talk	–
14	**Academic Talks IV: prediction and attitude**	Listen to an Academic Talk	–
15	**Holding information in memory**	All Listening tasks	–
16	**Adaptive mock test**	Full Listening section	–
17	**Review and personal study plan**	All Listening tasks	–

The 3-hour pattern

PHASE	TIME	YOUR ROLE
Warm-up	10 min	A quick activity that activates the day’s skill. Every plan suggests one.
Teacher-led	30–45 min	Present the strategy with the board plan, model it, and check understanding with the concept-check questions. On ETS lesson days, teach from the ETS plan and use BandSix for follow-up.
Platform	≈ 2 h	Students complete the BandSix day. Circulate, look at the checklist at the bottom of each day, give one-to-one feedback, and watch for the errors listed in the plan.
Wrap-up	10 min	Exit ticket and a preview of the next day. Remind students to send writing and recordings to Drive.

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ETS LESSON · ALL LISTENING TASKS

Day 1 · Inside the new Listening section

By the end of the class, students can describe the four Listening task types and the adaptive format, and take a short diagnostic.

Run sheet · 3-hour class

TIME	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	MIN
0:00–0:10	**Warm-up**	Play 60 seconds of a campus podcast at natural speed. Students write any five words they catch, then compare: what made it hard (speed, linking, vocabulary)?	10
0:10–0:45	**Teacher-led**	**ETS lesson:** Listening Lesson 1 · Listening Introduction. Present the strategy (see **Teach this**). On screen with the class: What the section looks like.	35
0:45–1:10	**Platform**	Diagnostic: one of each task (Guided practice)	25
1:10–1:45	**Platform**	Diagnostic part 2 (Guided practice)	35
1:45–2:00	**Platform**	Dictation: tune your ear (Toolkit)	15
2:00–2:08	**Platform**	Reflection (Reflection)	8
2:08–2:50	**Platform**	Buffer: students finish any unchecked activity, read every explanation and send recordings or writing to Drive. Use this time for one-to-one feedback.	42
2:50–3:00	**Wrap-up**	**Exit ticket:** write the task that was hardest to follow and what was missed (words, speed or meaning). Preview the next day.	10

Teach this (30–45 min)

- Follow ETS Listening Lesson 1 (Listening Introduction) as your core lesson.
- Present the four task types and the adaptive format, and stress the key difference from Reading: no going back, and each recording plays once.
- Explain that the challenge is processing speed, not stamina: all audio is short.
- Show how BandSix audio works: replay on while learning, 'Once only' for test practice, transcript only after answering.

Board plan

Choose a Response · Conversation · Announcement · Academic Talk
Audio plays ONCE · No going back
Answer → then transcript

Check understanding

Q: Can you replay the audio on the test?
A: No, once only.
Q: When should you read the transcript in BandSix?
A: After you answer, while listening again.

Watch for

- Reading the transcript before answering, which hides real listening problems.
- Low-quality robotic voices on some phones: show the Audio settings on the My progress page.

Differentiation

Support: Allow replay for weaker students on the diagnostic, but ask them to note how many plays they needed.

Stretch: Strong students set replay to 'Once only' from today.

Collect

- Auto-scored results appear in the student's progress report (My progress → Copy report).

Daily exposure (homework)

- Listen to 10 minutes of an English podcast made for learners (BBC 6 Minute English, VOA Learning English, All Ears English). First without a transcript, then with it.
- Watch one short YouTube video in English with English subtitles. Pause once a minute and repeat the last sentence aloud.
- Listen to one campus-style announcement or news bulletin and summarize it in one sentence.

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ETS LESSON · LISTEN AND CHOOSE A RESPONSE

Day 2 · Choose a Response I: question types

By the end of the class, students can identify the type of question you hear in the first two words and predict what a good reply must do.

Run sheet · 3-hour class

TIME	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	MIN
0:00–0:10	**Warm-up**	Rapid fire: you say a question, students say only the question type (WHEN, WHO, WHY, YES/NO, REQUEST, SUGGESTION).	10
0:10–0:45	**Teacher-led**	**ETS lesson:** Listening Lesson 2 · Listen and Choose a Response. Present the strategy (see **Teach this**). On screen with the class: Tutorial: Listen and Choose a Response; The first two words decide the answer.	35
0:45–1:10	**Platform**	Ten prompts (Guided practice)	25
1:10–1:15	**Platform**	Exit check (Exit check)	5
1:15–1:45	**Platform**	Extended practice: fifteen prompts (Guided practice)	30
1:45–2:05	**Platform**	Mixed review (Guided practice)	20
2:05–2:20	**Platform**	Dictation: question forms (Toolkit)	15
2:20–2:50	**Platform**	Buffer: students finish any unchecked activity, read every explanation and send recordings or writing to Drive. Use this time for one-to-one feedback.	30
2:50–3:00	**Wrap-up**	**Exit ticket:** you read four prompts; students write only the reply type for each. Preview the next day.	10

Teach this (30–45 min)

- Follow ETS Listening Lesson 2 (Listen and Choose a Response).
- Teach that the first two words decide the answer type; present the table from Who… to Why don't we….
- Model predicting the reply category before reading the options, then eliminating options of the wrong type.
- Name the two traps that look like questions: 'Why don't we…?' (suggestion) and 'Would you mind…?' (No = yes, OK).

Board plan

First 2 words → type → predict reply
Why don't we = suggestion
Would you mind…? → 'Not at all' = OK

Check understanding

Q: 'How often do you go?' Is 'For an hour' correct?
A: No, that answers how long.
Q: 'Why don't we study together?' Is the speaker asking for a reason?
A: No, it is a suggestion.

Watch for

- Answering 'Would you mind…?' with 'Yes, of course' meaning OK.
- Choosing options that repeat words from the prompt.

Differentiation

Support: Play each prompt twice for weaker students in the first ten items.

Stretch: Strong students write three new prompts and four options each for a partner.

Collect

- Auto-scored results appear in the student's progress report (My progress → Copy report).

Daily exposure (homework)

- Listen to 10 minutes of an English podcast made for learners (BBC 6 Minute English, VOA Learning English, All Ears English). First without a transcript, then with it.
- Watch one short YouTube video in English with English subtitles. Pause once a minute and repeat the last sentence aloud.
- Listen to one campus-style announcement or news bulletin and summarize it in one sentence.

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LISTEN AND CHOOSE A RESPONSE

Day 3 · Choose a Response II: indirect answers

By the end of the class, students can recognize natural replies that answer a question indirectly, and reply appropriately to statements that are not questions.

Run sheet · 3-hour class

TIME	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	MIN
0:00–0:10	**Warm-up**	Act out a short dialogue in which every answer is indirect (Did you finish? / My laptop died.). Students say what each reply really means.	10
0:10–0:45	**Teacher-led**	Present the strategy (see **Teach this**). On screen with the class: Real people rarely say “yes” or “no”.	35
0:45–1:10	**Platform**	Ten prompts (Guided practice)	25
1:10–1:40	**Platform**	Extended practice: fifteen indirect replies (Guided practice)	30
1:40–2:00	**Platform**	Mixed review (Guided practice)	20
2:00–2:15	**Platform**	Dictation: natural replies (Toolkit)	15
2:15–2:50	**Platform**	Buffer: students finish any unchecked activity, read every explanation and send recordings or writing to Drive. Use this time for one-to-one feedback.	35
2:50–3:00	**Wrap-up**	**Exit ticket:** write an indirect reply to 'Are you coming to the party?' meaning no. Preview the next day.	10

Teach this (30–45 min)

- Real replies rarely say yes or no; the correct option often implies the answer.
- Show the direct vs. indirect table and the test: would this be the natural next line?
- For statements, teach reply functions: complaint → sympathy or solution; news → reaction; offer → accept or refuse; information → follow-up question.
- Accept 'I don't know' replies: I'm not sure, let me check, they haven't announced it.

Board plan

Is it a natural next line?
Complaint → help · News → reaction · Offer → accept/refuse · Info → follow-up

Check understanding

Q: 'Did you get the email?' / 'My inbox has been down.' What does the reply mean?
A: No.
Q: What is a natural reply to good news?
A: A reaction, e.g. That's fantastic!

Watch for

- Rejecting correct indirect answers because they do not contain yes or no.
- Missing that a statement can be an implied request (I left my umbrella in your car).

Differentiation

Support: Pairs say each prompt and reply aloud to hear whether it sounds natural.

Stretch: Strong students write indirect replies for five direct questions.

Collect

- Auto-scored results appear in the student’s progress report (My progress → Copy report).

Daily exposure (homework)

- Watch a scene from an English TV series. Write down three questions and the replies. How many replies were indirect?
- Listen to 10 minutes of an English podcast made for learners (BBC 6 Minute English, VOA Learning English, All Ears English). First without a transcript, then with it.

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LISTEN AND CHOOSE A RESPONSE

Day 4 · Choose a Response III: sound traps

By the end of the class, students can avoid options that repeat or echo words from the prompt, and catch tense and person mismatches.

Run sheet · 3-hour class

TIME	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	MIN
0:00–0:10	**Warm-up**	Minimal pairs: say a word (copy/coffee, write/right, meet/meat, walk/work) and students hold up card A or B.	10
0:10–0:45	**Teacher-led**	Present the strategy (see **Teach this**). On screen with the class: How wrong options are built.	35
0:45–1:10	**Platform**	Ten prompts (Guided practice)	25
1:10–1:40	**Platform**	Extended practice: fifteen trap-filled prompts (Guided practice)	30
1:40–2:00	**Platform**	Mixed review (Guided practice)	20
2:00–2:15	**Platform**	Dictation: minimal pairs in context (Toolkit)	15
2:15–2:50	**Platform**	Buffer: students finish any unchecked activity, read every explanation and send recordings or writing to Drive. Use this time for one-to-one feedback.	35
2:50–3:00	**Wrap-up**	**Exit ticket:** you read three prompts with trap options; students name the trap type in each. Preview the next day.	10

Teach this (30–45 min)

- Present how wrong options are built: repeated word, sound-alike, related word, wrong tense, wrong person, wrong question type.
- Teach 'distrust the echo': check any option that repeats a word you heard.
- Show tense and person checks with examples (Will you come? / I came...).
- Model a full item, thinking aloud about why each trap fails.

Board plan

Echo · Sound-alike · Related word · Wrong tense · Wrong person → meaning beats sound

Check understanding

Q: 'Will you come on Friday?' Is 'I came on Friday' possible?
A: No, wrong tense.
Q: An option repeats two words from the prompt. What should you do?
A: Check its meaning twice; it is often a trap.

Watch for

- Sound confusions common for Spanish speakers: ship/sheep, live/leave, work/walk, b/v.
- Ignoring tense in the prompt.

Differentiation

Support: Weaker students do the dictation of minimal pairs first, then the prompts.

Stretch: Strong students listen at speed 1.05 in Audio settings.

Collect

- Auto-scored results appear in the student's progress report (My progress → Copy report).

Daily exposure (homework)

- Listen to 5 minutes of any podcast at 1.25× speed, then 5 minutes at normal speed. Normal speed will feel slower.
- Watch one short YouTube video in English with English subtitles. Pause once a minute and repeat the last sentence aloud.

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ETS LESSON · CHOOSE A RESPONSE · CONVERSATION

Day 5 · Stress, intonation and implied meaning

By the end of the class, students can understand what speakers mean from stress, intonation and common expressions, not just from the words.

Run sheet · 3-hour class

TIME	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	MIN
0:00–0:10	**Warm-up**	Say one sentence with stress on different words (I didn't take your notes / I didn't take YOUR notes). Students explain each meaning.	10
0:10–0:45	**Teacher-led**	**ETS lesson:** Listening Lesson 4 · Stress and Intonation. Present the strategy (see **Teach this**). On screen with the class: Meaning beyond the words.	35
0:45–1:10	**Platform**	Expressions in context (Guided practice)	25
1:10–1:45	**Platform**	Extended practice: expressions in conversations (Guided practice)	35
1:45–2:00	**Platform**	Mixed review (Guided practice)	15
2:00–2:15	**Platform**	Dictation: everyday expressions (Toolkit)	15
2:15–2:50	**Platform**	Buffer: students finish any unchecked activity, read every explanation and send recordings or writing to Drive. Use this time for one-to-one feedback.	35
2:50–3:00	**Wrap-up**	**Exit ticket:** write the real meaning of three expressions from today. Preview the next day.	10

Teach this (30–45 min)

- Follow ETS Listening Lesson 4 (Stress and Intonation).
- Stress marks new or contrasting information; rising intonation on a statement shows surprise or a question.
- Teach the expressions table (Tell me about it, I wish!, Not that I know of, Count me in, rain check).
- Model a conversation where the expression decides the answer.

Board plan

Stress = new / contrast
↗ statement = surprise
Tell me about it = I agree · I wish! = no, but I'd like to

Check understanding

Q: 'Are you coming?' / 'I wish!' Is the speaker coming?
A: No.
Q: 'I'll take a rain check.' Yes or no?
A: Not now, maybe another time.

Watch for

- Literal translations of idioms ('Tell me about it' heard as a request for information).
- Flat intonation when students repeat the drills.

Differentiation

Support: Give the expressions table in print and ask students to tick each one as they meet it.

Stretch: Strong students use three expressions in a short role-play recorded on their phone.

Collect

- Auto-scored results appear in the student's progress report (My progress → Copy report).

Daily exposure (homework)

- Learn 5 new everyday expressions from a TV series and use one in your next class.
- Watch one short YouTube video in English with English subtitles. Pause once a minute and repeat the last sentence aloud.

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ETS LESSON · LISTEN TO A CONVERSATION

Day 6 · Conversations I: gist and purpose

By the end of the class, students can identify what a conversation is about and why the speakers are talking, from the first exchanges.

Run sheet · 3-hour class

TIME	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	MIN
0:00–0:10	**Warm-up**	Show the first two lines of a conversation and ask: who are they, what is the problem, what will happen next?	10
0:10–0:45	**Teacher-led**	**ETS lesson:** Listening Lesson 3 · Living in a Dorm. Present the strategy (see **Teach this**). On screen with the class: Tutorial: Listen to a Conversation; The first ten seconds.	35
0:45–1:20	**Platform**	Four conversations (Guided practice)	35
1:20–1:55	**Platform**	Extended practice: five more conversations (Guided practice)	35
1:55–2:10	**Platform**	Mixed review (Guided practice)	15
2:10–2:25	**Platform**	Dictation: campus conversations (Toolkit)	15
2:25–2:50	**Platform**	Buffer: students finish any unchecked activity, read every explanation and send recordings or writing to Drive. Use this time for one-to-one feedback.	25
2:50–3:00	**Wrap-up**	**Exit ticket:** one-sentence gist of the last conversation. Preview the next day.	10

Teach this (30–45 min)

- Follow ETS Listening Lesson 3 (Living in a Dorm) as your conversation lesson.
- Teach the conversation path: problem → suggestion → decision.
- Identify roles early: friends, student and advisor, customer and employee.
- Teach silent gist: say the gist to yourself in one sentence as soon as the audio ends.

Board plan

Problem → suggestion → decision
Who? What problem? What will they do?

Check understanding

Q: Where is the answer to 'What will the woman do?' usually found?
A: Near the end, often after 'I'll…'.
Q: What do you identify in the first ten seconds?
A: The roles and the problem.

Watch for

- Writing notes during the audio and missing the next line.
- Confusing who says what in the decision.

Differentiation

Support: Let weaker students see the setting line and predict three likely words before listening.

Stretch: Strong students summarize each conversation aloud in one sentence before checking answers.

Collect

- Auto-scored results appear in the student's progress report (My progress → Copy report).

Daily exposure (homework)

- Listen to 10 minutes of an English podcast made for learners (BBC 6 Minute English, VOA Learning English, All Ears English). First without a transcript, then with it.
- Watch one short YouTube video in English with English subtitles. Pause once a minute and repeat the last sentence aloud.
- Listen to one campus-style announcement or news bulletin and summarize it in one sentence.

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LISTEN TO A CONVERSATION

Day 7 · Conversations II: suggestions and next actions

By the end of the class, students can catch suggestions, offers and decisions, and predict what a speaker will do next.

Run sheet · 3-hour class

TIME	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	MIN
0:00–0:10	**Warm-up**	Students give each other advice on a problem (I can't sleep) using as many suggestion forms as possible in two minutes.	10
0:10–0:45	**Teacher-led**	Present the strategy (see **Teach this**). On screen with the class: The language of suggestions.	35
0:45–1:20	**Platform**	Four conversations (Guided practice)	35
1:20–1:55	**Platform**	Extended practice: five conversations about decisions (Guided practice)	35
1:55–2:15	**Platform**	Mixed review (Guided practice)	20
2:15–2:30	**Platform**	Dictation: suggestions and decisions (Toolkit)	15
2:30–2:50	**Platform**	Buffer: students finish any unchecked activity, read every explanation and send recordings or writing to Drive. Use this time for one-to-one feedback.	20
2:50–3:00	**Wrap-up**	**Exit ticket:** write the decision from two conversations. Preview the next day.	10

Teach this (30–45 min)

- Present the language of suggestions, offers, decisions and refusals.
- Teach that after a suggestion you must listen for the reaction: tests often ask what the other person decides.
- 'I'll...' near the end is almost always the next action.
- Model with the advisor conversation (calculus and tutoring).

Board plan

Suggest: Why don't you...? Have you thought about...?
Offer: Want me to...?
Decide: I'll... / I guess I'll...

Check understanding

Q: The advisor suggests tutoring. The student says 'I'll try the tutoring first.' What will he do?
A: Go to tutoring.
Q: Is 'If I were you, I'd...' a suggestion or a fact?
A: A suggestion.

Watch for

- Choosing the first suggestion even when the speaker rejects it.
- Missing 'I'd rather not' as a refusal.

Differentiation

Support: Weaker students mark each line of the transcript as S (suggestion), R (reaction) or D (decision) after answering.

Stretch: Strong students write a 6-line conversation with a rejected and an accepted suggestion.

Collect

- Auto-scored results appear in the student's progress report (My progress → Copy report).

Daily exposure (homework)

- Listen to one advice podcast or video. Count how many different ways the speaker makes suggestions.
- Listen to 10 minutes of an English podcast made for learners (BBC 6 Minute English, VOA Learning English, All Ears English). First without a transcript, then with it.

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ETS LESSON · LISTEN TO A CONVERSATION

Day 8 · Conversations III: inference and speaker attitude

By the end of the class, students can infer what speakers think, feel and already know, including why a speaker says a particular phrase.

Run sheet · 3-hour class

TIME	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	MIN
0:00–0:10	**Warm-up**	Say 'Well... the lights were amazing' about a concert in a hesitant voice. Ask: did the speaker enjoy the music?	10
0:10–0:45	**Teacher-led**	**ETS lesson:** Listening Lesson 5 · Choosing a Presentation Topic. Present the strategy (see **Teach this**). On screen with the class: What does the speaker imply?.	35
0:45–1:20	**Platform**	Four conversations (Guided practice)	35
1:20–1:55	**Platform**	Extended practice: five conversations with hidden meaning (Guided practice)	35
1:55–2:15	**Platform**	Mixed review (Guided practice)	20
2:15–2:30	**Platform**	Dictation: tone and attitude (Toolkit)	15
2:30–2:50	**Platform**	Buffer: students finish any unchecked activity, read every explanation and send recordings or writing to Drive. Use this time for one-to-one feedback.	20
2:50–3:00	**Wrap-up**	**Exit ticket:** one inference about a speaker's attitude with the words that show it. Preview the next day.	10

Teach this (30–45 min)

- Follow ETS Listening Lesson 5 (Choosing a Presentation Topic).
- Teach attitude signals: hesitation (Well..., I mean...), 'but', polite indirect criticism.
- For 'Why does the speaker say...?' questions, think function: apologizing, disagreeing politely, surprise, changing topic.
- Infer what is taken for granted: 'Aren't we going to...?' shows an earlier plan.

Board plan

Well... = doubt · but = real opinion
Why say X? → function (apologize, disagree, joke...)

Check understanding

Q: 'It's interesting, but half the class will choose it.' Does the speaker like the topic?
A: Not really; it is too common.
Q: 'Aren't we meeting at seven?' What did the speaker believe?
A: That there was a plan to meet at seven.

Watch for

- Taking polite praise literally.
- Missing sarcasm and humour.

Differentiation

Support: Play the attitude lines twice and ask students to describe the tone in one word.

Stretch: Strong students rewrite one line to change the speaker's attitude.

Collect

- Auto-scored results appear in the student's progress report (My progress → Copy report).

Daily exposure (homework)

- While listening to a podcast conversation, pause after an opinion and guess: does the other speaker agree? Then check.
- Watch one short YouTube video in English with English subtitles. Pause once a minute and repeat the last sentence aloud.

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LISTEN TO AN ANNOUNCEMENT

Day 9 · Announcements I: purpose and action

By the end of the class, students can identify why an announcement is being made and what listeners are asked to do.

Run sheet · 3-hour class

TIME	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	MIN
0:00–0:10	**Warm-up**	Read a real announcement (library closing). Students say its job in five words.	10
0:10–0:45	**Teacher-led**	Present the strategy (see **Teach this**). On screen with the class: Tutorial: Listen to an Announcement; Every announcement has a job.	35
0:45–1:20	**Platform**	Four announcements (Guided practice)	35
1:20–1:55	**Platform**	Extended practice: five announcements (Guided practice)	35
1:55–2:15	**Platform**	Mixed review (Guided practice)	20
2:15–2:30	**Platform**	Dictation: announcement language (Toolkit)	15
2:30–2:50	**Platform**	Buffer: students finish any unchecked activity, read every explanation and send recordings or writing to Drive. Use this time for one-to-one feedback.	20
2:50–3:00	**Wrap-up**	**Exit ticket:** purpose and instruction of the last announcement. Preview the next day.	10

Teach this (30–45 min)

- Every announcement has a job: change, event, warning or request; the sentence after the opening phrase usually gives it.
- Catch the instruction: please…, make sure…, you'll need to….
- Listen for reasons: due to, because, since.
- Model with the classroom announcement (new room, laptops).

Board plan

Opening → purpose
Change · Event · Warning · Request
please / make sure / due to

Check understanding

Q: 'Due to track maintenance…' What follows 'due to'?
A: The reason.
Q: 'Please bring your laptop.' What type of information is this?
A: An instruction.

Watch for

- Choosing a detail as the purpose.
- Missing 'not' in instructions (will not lend).

Differentiation

Support: Students write P (purpose), I (instruction) and R (reason) while listening.

Stretch: Strong students write and record their own campus announcement.

Collect

- Auto-scored results appear in the student's progress report (My progress → Copy report).

Daily exposure (homework)

- Listen to 10 minutes of an English podcast made for learners (BBC 6 Minute English, VOA Learning English). First without a transcript, then with it.
- Watch one short lecture-style video (TED-Ed, CrashCourse, Khan Academy). After it ends, say the main idea and two details aloud.
- Listen to one news bulletin or announcement and summarize it in one sentence.

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LISTEN TO AN ANNOUNCEMENT

Day 10 · Announcements II: details under pressure

By the end of the class, students can hold times, places, numbers and conditions in memory long enough to answer detail questions.

Run sheet · 3-hour class

TIME	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	MIN
0:00–0:10	**Warm-up**	Dictate a fast list (Tuesday, 3:15, Room 204, graduate students only) and ask students to repeat it from memory.	10
0:10–0:45	**Teacher-led**	Present the strategy (see **Teach this**). On screen with the class: Details are the answers.	35
0:45–1:15	**Platform**	Four announcements (Guided practice)	30
1:15–1:20	**Platform**	Exit check (Exit check)	5
1:20–1:55	**Platform**	Extended practice: five detail-heavy announcements (Guided practice)	35
1:55–2:15	**Platform**	Mixed review (Guided practice)	20
2:15–2:30	**Platform**	Dictation: numbers and dates (Toolkit)	15
2:30–2:50	**Platform**	Buffer: students finish any unchecked activity, read every explanation and send recordings or writing to Drive. Use this time for one-to-one feedback.	20
2:50–3:00	**Wrap-up**	**Exit ticket:** dictate four numbers in context (thirteen vs thirty) and check. Preview the next day.	10

Teach this (30–45 min)

- Details are the answers: sort facts by WHEN, WHERE, WHO, WHAT TO DO.
- Listen for corrections: 'was going to be Monday, but now…'. The test asks for the final information.
- Conditions (only, unless, as long as, except) change who is included.
- Say numbers silently once to keep them in working memory.

Board plan

When · Where · Who · What to do
Changed info → take the FINAL one
only / unless / except

Check understanding

Q: 'It was Monday, but now it's Wednesday.' When is it?
A: Wednesday.
Q: 'Free unless you arrive after 9.' Who pays?
A: People who arrive after 9.

Watch for

- Choosing the old time or place after a change.
- Number confusions (13/30, 15/50, 14/40).

Differentiation

Support: Weaker students listen with a WHEN/WHERE/WHO/WHAT grid in front of them.

Stretch: Strong students do the numbers dictation at test speed.

Collect

- Auto-scored results appear in the student's progress report (My progress → Copy report).

Daily exposure (homework)

- Listen to a weather forecast or traffic report in English. Write down three numbers from memory after it ends.
- Listen to one news bulletin or announcement and summarize it in one sentence.

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LISTEN TO AN ACADEMIC TALK

Day 11 · Academic Talks I: topic and organization

By the end of the class, students can identify the topic of a short lecture and follow its structure through signpost language.

Run sheet · 3-hour class

TIME	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	MIN
0:00–0:10	**Warm-up**	Show the signpost phrases on cards; students sort them into introduce, add, example, contrast, next.	10
0:10–0:45	**Teacher-led**	Present the strategy (see **Teach this**). On screen with the class: Tutorial: Listen to an Academic Talk; Signposts show the map.	35
0:45–1:15	**Platform**	Two talks (Guided practice)	30
1:15–1:50	**Platform**	Extended practice: three academic talks (Guided practice)	35
1:50–2:05	**Platform**	Mixed review (Guided practice)	15
2:05–2:20	**Platform**	Dictation: signpost language (Toolkit)	15
2:20–2:50	**Platform**	Buffer: students finish any unchecked activity, read every explanation and send recordings or writing to Drive. Use this time for one-to-one feedback.	30
2:50–3:00	**Wrap-up**	**Exit ticket:** write the outline of one talk in three lines. Preview the next day.	10

Teach this (30–45 min)

- The topic is almost always in the first two or three sentences.
- Signposts build a mental map: introduce, define, add, example, contrast, emphasize, next.
- Hold a mental outline: topic → point → example → point.
- The last sentence often predicts the next topic.

Board plan

Today we're looking at... = topic
Take... / For instance = example
However = contrast
Next time... = next

Check understanding

Q: 'Take the ground squirrel...' What does 'take' introduce?
A: An example.
Q: Where do you usually find what comes next?
A: In the last sentence.

Watch for

- Treating an early example as the topic.
- Losing the thread after an unfamiliar word.

Differentiation

Support: Weaker students draw a three-box outline (topic / example / next) while listening.

Stretch: Strong students summarize a TED-Ed video using the signposts they heard.

Collect

- Auto-scored results appear in the student's progress report (My progress → Copy report).

Daily exposure (homework)

- Watch one TED-Ed video (4–5 minutes). Write the signpost phrases you hear.
- Watch one short lecture-style video (TED-Ed, CrashCourse, Khan Academy). After it ends, say the main idea and two details aloud.

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LISTEN TO AN ACADEMIC TALK

Day 12 · Academic Talks II: examples and purpose

By the end of the class, students can explain why a speaker mentions an example, a story or a question during a talk.

Run sheet · 3-hour class

TIME	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	MIN
0:00–0:10	**Warm-up**	Tell a 30-second personal story that leads into a concept (e.g. a huge menu → decision fatigue). Ask what the story was for.	10
0:10–0:45	**Teacher-led**	Present the strategy (see **Teach this**). On screen with the class: Why does the speaker mention…?.	35
0:45–1:20	**Platform**	Two talks (Guided practice)	35
1:20–1:55	**Platform**	Extended practice: three talks with examples (Guided practice)	35
1:55–2:10	**Platform**	Mixed review (Guided practice)	15
2:10–2:25	**Platform**	Dictation: examples and explanations (Toolkit)	15
2:25–2:50	**Platform**	Buffer: students finish any unchecked activity, read every explanation and send recordings or writing to Drive. Use this time for one-to-one feedback.	25
2:50–3:00	**Wrap-up**	**Exit ticket:** 'The speaker mentions ___ to ___' for one talk. Preview the next day.	10

Teach this (30–45 min)

- Stories, questions to the audience and everyday examples almost never are the topic; they introduce or illustrate a concept.
- Present the function table: story at the start = introduce; 'for example' after a definition = illustrate; 'You might think… but' = correct a misunderstanding.
- Ask 'What idea is this going to explain?' every time a story starts.
- Model with the restaurant and judges talk.

Board plan

> Story → introduce · For example → illustrate · Question → make you think · You might think… → correct

Check understanding

Q: The professor starts with her weekend at a restaurant. Is the talk about restaurants?
A: No, it introduces a concept.
Q: 'You might think… but…' What is the speaker doing?
A: Correcting a common misunderstanding.

Watch for

- Answering with the content of the story instead of its purpose.
- Getting lost in a story's details.

Differentiation

Support: Students write the concept name as soon as they hear it.

Stretch: Strong students explain why the speaker chose that particular example.

Collect

- Auto-scored results appear in the student's progress report (My progress → Copy report).

Daily exposure (homework)

- In the next lecture video you watch, note every example the speaker gives and write what idea it illustrates.
- Listen to 10 minutes of an English podcast made for learners (BBC 6 Minute English, VOA Learning English). First without a transcript, then with it.

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LISTEN TO AN ACADEMIC TALK

Day 13 · Academic Talks III: definitions and comparisons

By the end of the class, students can catch definitions of key terms and keep track of the differences between two concepts.

Run sheet · 3-hour class

TIME	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	MIN
0:00–0:10	**Warm-up**	Two-column race: students list differences between two familiar things (bus vs taxi) in one minute.	10
0:10–0:45	**Teacher-led**	Present the strategy (see **Teach this**). On screen with the class: Two-type talks.	35
0:45–1:20	**Platform**	Two talks (Guided practice)	35
1:20–1:55	**Platform**	Extended practice: three two-concept talks (Guided practice)	35
1:55–2:10	**Platform**	Mixed review (Guided practice)	15
2:10–2:25	**Platform**	Dictation: contrast language (Toolkit)	15
2:25–2:50	**Platform**	Buffer: students finish any unchecked activity, read every explanation and send recordings or writing to Drive. Use this time for one-to-one feedback.	25
2:50–3:00	**Wrap-up**	**Exit ticket:** write the two concepts from one talk and one feature of each. Preview the next day.	10

Teach this (30–45 min)

- Many short talks compare two types; build a mental two-column table.
- Catch the name of each type and attach one feature to each.
- Listen for the switch: in contrast, whereas, unlike, on the other hand.
- Expect a question on each type and one on which description matches which.

Board plan

Type A
Type B — feature · feature
whereas · unlike · on the other hand

Check understanding

Q: 'Weather is short-term, whereas climate is long-term.' Which word signals the contrast?
A: Whereas.
Q: A diary written during a war: primary or secondary source?
A: Primary.

Watch for

- Mixing up which feature belongs to which type.
- Missing the definition sentence (X refers to…).

Differentiation

Support: Weaker students fill a two-column table while listening.

Stretch: Strong students explain the difference between two concepts from their own field in 45 seconds.

Collect

- Auto-scored results appear in the student’s progress report (My progress → Copy report).

Daily exposure (homework)

- Choose any two related concepts from your major. Explain the difference aloud in 45 seconds, using “whereas” or “on the other hand”.
- Watch one short lecture-style video (TED-Ed, CrashCourse, Khan Academy). After it ends, say the main idea and two details aloud.

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LISTEN TO AN ACADEMIC TALK

Day 14 · Academic Talks IV: prediction and attitude

By the end of the class, students can infer the speaker's opinion and predict what the speaker will discuss next.

Run sheet · 3-hour class

TIME	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	MIN
0:00–0:10	**Warm-up**	Read three sentences with different certainty (clearly / it seems / unfortunately). Students rate how sure the speaker is.	10
0:10–0:45	**Teacher-led**	Present the strategy (see **Teach this**). On screen with the class: Reading the speaker.	35
0:45–1:20	**Platform**	Two talks (Guided practice)	35
1:20–1:55	**Platform**	Extended practice: three talks, attitude and prediction (Guided practice)	35
1:55–2:10	**Platform**	Mixed review (Guided practice)	15
2:10–2:25	**Platform**	Dictation: attitude words (Toolkit)	15
2:25–2:50	**Platform**	Buffer: students finish any unchecked activity, read every explanation and send recordings or writing to Drive. Use this time for one-to-one feedback.	25
2:50–3:00	**Wrap-up**	**Exit ticket:** the speaker's attitude in one talk and the word that shows it. Preview the next day.	10

Teach this (30–45 min)

- Evaluative words show attitude (remarkable, unfortunately); hedging shows uncertainty (may, it seems, is debated); strong words show confidence.
- Predict the next topic from endings such as 'Next, we'll…'.
- Model the traffic and roads talk, focusing on 'Unfortunately, the evidence shows…'.
- Ask students to name the attitude word before choosing any option.

Board plan

Attitude: unfortunately · surprisingly
Hedging: may · seems · debated
Next: Next, we'll…

Check understanding

Q: 'Some researchers believe…' Is this the speaker's own view?
A: Not necessarily; it reports others.
Q: 'Surprisingly, traffic didn't get worse.' How does the speaker feel?
A: Surprised.

Watch for

- Confusing the speaker's view with the view the speaker reports from others.
- Choosing an extreme attitude (angry) for mild criticism.

Differentiation

Support: Give a list of attitude words with + / – / ? labels.

Stretch: Strong students identify the attitude words in a podcast episode.

Collect

- Auto-scored results appear in the student's progress report (My progress → Copy report).

Daily exposure (homework)

- While listening to a podcast, note one sentence where the speaker shows an opinion. Which word gave it away?
- Listen to 10 minutes of an English podcast made for learners (BBC 6 Minute English, VOA Learning English). First without a transcript, then with it.

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ALL LISTENING TASKS

Day 15 · Holding information in memory

By the end of the class, students can use prediction, visualization and silent summarizing to remember more of what you hear the first time.

Run sheet · 3-hour class

TIME	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	MIN
0:00–0:10	**Warm-up**	Memory chain: each student repeats the previous sentences and adds one (I went to the market and bought…).	10
0:10–0:45	**Teacher-led**	Present the strategy (see **Teach this**). On screen with the class: Memory is a strategy, not a talent.	35
0:45–1:15	**Platform**	Mixed set, replay off (Guided practice)	30
1:15–1:50	**Platform**	Extended practice: memory under pressure (Guided practice)	35
1:50–2:05	**Platform**	Dictation: longer sentences (Toolkit)	15
2:05–2:50	**Platform**	Buffer: students finish any unchecked activity, read every explanation and send recordings or writing to Drive. Use this time for one-to-one feedback.	45
2:50–3:00	**Wrap-up**	**Exit ticket:** which memory technique helped most today, and why. Preview the next day.	10

Teach this (30–45 min)

- Memory is a strategy: predict from the setting, visualize, chunk meaning groups, summarize silently every 20–30 seconds.
- Teach calm recovery: if you miss a detail, let it go and focus on the next part.
- Link to Speaking: the same techniques help Listen and Repeat.
- Set replay to 'Once only' for the whole class today.

Board plan

Predict · Visualize · Chunk · Silent summary every 20–30 s · Let it go

Check understanding

Q: What should you do if you miss a detail?
A: Let it go and focus on the next part.
Q: How often should you summarize silently?
A: Every 20–30 seconds.

Watch for

- Students trying to remember every word.
- Panic after one missed detail.

Differentiation

Support: Allow weaker students one replay on the first conversation only.

Stretch: Strong students do the long dictation sentences without replay.

Collect

- Auto-scored results appear in the student’s progress report (My progress → Copy report).

Daily exposure (homework)

- After any video or podcast episode, close it and say three things you remember in order, without looking.
- Watch one short lecture-style video (TED-Ed, CrashCourse, Khan Academy). After it ends, say the main idea and two details aloud.

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FULL LISTENING SECTION

Day 16 · Adaptive mock test

By the end of the class, students can take a two-module Listening test with single playback and see which Module 2 route you reach.

Run sheet · 3-hour class

TIME	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	MIN
0:00–0:10	**Warm-up**	Two minutes to review the rules: audio once, no going back, answer every question.	10
0:10–0:45	**Teacher-led**	Present the strategy (see **Teach this**).	35
0:45–1:15	**Platform**	Listening mock: two modules (Mock test)	30
1:15–1:55	**Platform**	Second practice module (not adaptive) (Timed task)	40
1:55–2:03	**Platform**	Reflection (Reflection)	8
2:03–2:50	**Platform**	Buffer: students finish any unchecked activity, read every explanation and send recordings or writing to Drive. Use this time for one-to-one feedback.	47
2:50–3:00	**Wrap-up**	**Exit ticket:** route, total and the moment they lost concentration. Preview the next day.	10

Teach this (30–45 min)

- Brief instructions only: single playback in the mock whatever the replay setting, 60% cut for the upper Module 2.
- Run the mock under test conditions, with headphones if possible.
- Explain that the percentage is for comparison, not a band score.
- Students then complete the second practice module with replay set to Once only.

Board plan

Audio plays once · Questions after the audio · 60% → upper route

Check understanding

Q: Can you replay audio in the mock?
A: No.
Q: What does your Module 1 score decide?
A: Which Module 2 you get.

Watch for

- Students using the 'Show questions without audio' button to read ahead.
- Noise in the classroom: stagger headphones or use separate rooms.

Differentiation

Support: Seat students who need it closer to the speakers or give them headphones first.

Stretch: Students on the upper route also do the dictation challenge set.

Collect

- Mock result: route and total appear in the student’s progress report (My progress → Copy report).

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ALL LISTENING TASKS

Day 17 · Review and personal study plan

By the end of the class, students can analyze your Listening results, practice once more and plan your listening exposure until test day.

Run sheet · 3-hour class

TIME	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	MIN
0:00–0:10	**Warm-up**	Students open My progress and write their two weakest Listening bars.	10
0:10–0:45	**Teacher-led**	Present the strategy (see **Teach this**). On screen with the class: Read your own data.	35
0:45–1:10	**Platform**	Final mixed set (Guided practice)	25
1:10–1:50	**Platform**	Final mixed set (Timed task)	40
1:50–2:05	**Platform**	Dictation: final challenge (Toolkit)	15
2:05–2:20	**Platform**	Your plan to test day (Reflection)	15
2:20–2:50	**Platform**	Buffer: students finish any unchecked activity, read every explanation and send recordings or writing to Drive. Use this time for one-to-one feedback.	30
2:50–3:00	**Wrap-up**	**Exit ticket:** students read their listening routine to a partner. Preview the next day.	10

Teach this (30–45 min)

- Show how to match weak tasks to days to repeat.
- Stress exposure over practice: 20 minutes of listening every day beats two hours on Sunday.
- Help students build a daily listening routine (what, how long, when).
- Hold short conferences during the final mixed set.

Board plan

Choose a Response 2–5 ·
Conversations 6–8 · Announcements 9–10 · Talks 11–14 · Memory 15
20 min/day

Check understanding

Q: Your Announcements bar is low. Which days do you repeat?
A: Days 9 and 10.
Q: Which is better: 20 minutes daily or 2 hours on Sunday?
A: 20 minutes daily.

Watch for

- Routines that rely only on Netflix with Spanish subtitles.
- Plans without a specific time of day.

Differentiation

Support: Offer a list of three podcasts at the right level.

Stretch: Strong students commit to one academic podcast episode per day without transcript.

Collect

- Auto-scored results appear in the student's progress report (My progress → Copy report).

Daily exposure (homework)

- Listen to 10 minutes of an English podcast made for learners (BBC 6 Minute English, VOA Learning English). First without a transcript, then with it.
- Watch one short lecture-style video (TED-Ed, CrashCourse, Khan Academy). After it ends, say the main idea and two details aloud.
- Listen to one news bulletin or announcement and summarize it in one sentence.

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